

Angry Parent Burnout Recovery — Action Checklist

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BUILD BIOLOGICAL FOUNDATION

- ☐ **Build Biological Foundation:** Prioritize eating protein-rich foods every 3-4 hours throughout the day because low blood sugar directly impairs your brain's ability to regulate emotions and keep your reactions measured.
- ☐ **Build Biological Foundation:** Track your sleep debt honestly and lower your expectations of yourself on low-sleep days because sleep deprivation raises emotional reactivity to levels equivalent to being legally too drunk to drive.
- ☐ **Build Biological Foundation:** Claim 90 seconds of completely alone time twice daily, even if it means closing a bathroom door, because brief physical separation from sensory input begins resetting an overstimulated nervous system.
- ☐ **Build Biological Foundation:** Keep accessible protein-rich snacks within arm's reach during parenting hours because skipping meals leaves your brain without the fuel it needs to maintain calm, rational responses.

SPOT YOUR WARNING SIGNS

- ☐ **Spot Your Warning Signs:** Notice the physical location in your body where frustration begins to build — chest tightness, stomach knots, or a rising sensation — because this is your window to act before dysregulation takes over.
- ☐ **Spot Your Warning Signs:** Watch for thoughts that accelerate into absolutes like 'why does he ALWAYS' because catastrophic thinking is a reliable signal that your nervous system is crossing into fight-or-flight territory.
- ☐ **Spot Your Warning Signs:** Identify whether your voice sharpens or your hands tighten into fists as personal warning signs because these physical changes happen before full dysregulation and signal that you need to pause.
- ☐ **Spot Your Warning Signs:** Learn to recognize the specific sequence of your own warning signs because the gap between the first sign and losing control is where intervention becomes possible.

USE THE PAUSE WITHOUT GUILT

- ☐ **Use the Pause Without Guilt:** Practice saying 'I need to take a breath and I'll be right back' so you have a scripted response ready because blurting out a pause is easier than improvising in a charged moment.

 - ☐ **Use the Pause Without Guilt:** Walk to the bathroom, hallway, or bedroom for 60 seconds when you feel anger rising because physical distance from your child creates the space needed to choose a different response.

 - ☐ **Use the Pause Without Guilt:** Breathe deliberately while alone for 60 seconds rather than suppressing your frustration because suppressing feelings makes them stronger while acknowledging them privately allows them to settle.

 - ☐ **Use the Pause Without Guilt:** Return to your child after the pause and resume parenting because this teaches them that adults manage emotions without abandoning relationships, which models regulation in real time.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.